

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE AMENDMENT
TO
2 ENGROSSED SENATE BILL NO. 1632 By: Alvord of the Senate
3 and
4 Hasenbeck of the House
5

6 An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
7 Section 14-135, which relates to career-readiness
8 assessments; directing the State Department of
9 Education, rather than the Oklahoma Department of
10 Commerce, in certain cooperation to approve certain
11 assessments and credentials; removing language making
12 such approval subject to funding; directing the
assessments to be made available to students in
certain grades beginning in certain school year;
directing the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
Education in certain consultation to promulgate
certain rules; providing an effective date; and
declaring an emergency.

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14 AMENDMENT NO. 1. Strike the title, enacting clause, and entire bill
15 and insert:

16 "An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
17 Section 14-135, which relates to career-readiness
18 assessments; directing the State Department of
19 Education, rather than the Oklahoma Department of
20 Commerce, in certain cooperation to approve certain
21 assessments and credentials; removing language making
22 such approval subject to funding; directing the
assessments to be made available to students in
certain grades beginning in certain school year;
directing the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
Education in certain consultation to promulgate
certain rules; providing an effective date; and
declaring an emergency.

23
24 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

1 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-135, is
2 amended to read as follows:

3 Section 14-135. ~~Subject to the availability of funds, beginning~~
4 ~~with the 2019-2020 school year, the Oklahoma Department of Commerce,~~
5 ~~in cooperation with the~~

6 A. The State Department of Education and, in cooperation with
7 the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, shall
8 review and approve career-readiness assessments and assessment-based
9 credentials that measure and document foundational workplace skills.
10 Beginning with the ~~2019-2020~~ 2026-2027 school year, the assessments
11 shall be made available to all public school districts to be
12 administered ~~to students~~ at the discretion of each school district's
13 administration to students in grades ten through twelve at least
14 once prior to their graduation from high school. The assessment-
15 based credential shall be available to any student who achieves the
16 prescribed level on the required ~~assessments~~ assessment. If the
17 public school district chooses to administer the assessments, the
18 assessments shall be administered at least once to each student who
19 chooses to take the assessment at no cost to the student. The
20 assessments shall:

- 21 1. Be a standardized, criterion-referenced measure of broadly
22 relevant foundational workplace skills;
- 23 2. Assess and document student readiness for a wide range of
24 jobs;

1 3. Measure skills in the following areas, including, but not
2 limited to:

- 3 a. applied mathematics,
- 4 b. workplace documents,
- 5 c. graphic literacy, or
- 6 d. critical thinking and leadership collaboration;

7 4. Align with research-based skill requirement profiles for
8 specific industries and occupations;

9 5. Lead to nationally recognized work-readiness certificates or
10 credentials for students who meet the minimum proficiency
11 requirements on the component assessments; and

12 6. Be available in paper- and computer-based formats.

13 B. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, in
14 consultation with the American Council on Education National Guide,
15 may promulgate rules to allow institutions of higher education
16 within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education to grant
17 college credit based on assessment-based credentials and scores
18 earned on career-readiness assessments.

19 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

20 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
21 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
22 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
23 be in full force from and after its passage and approval."
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1 Passed the House of Representatives the 6th day of May, 2026.

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4 Presiding Officer of the House of
Representatives
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6 Passed the Senate the ____ day of _____, 2026.
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9 Presiding Officer of the Senate
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2 BILL NO. 1632

By: Alvord of the Senate

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9 Education, rather than the Oklahoma Department of
10 Commerce, in certain cooperation to approve certain
11 assessments and credentials; removing language making
12 such approval subject to funding; directing the
13 assessments to be made available to students in
14 certain grades beginning in certain school year;
15 directing the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
16 Education in certain consultation to promulgate
17 certain rules; providing an effective date; and
18 declaring an emergency.

19 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

20 SECTION 4. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-135, is
21 amended to read as follows:

22 Section 14-135. ~~Subject to the availability of funds, beginning~~
23 ~~with the 2019-2020 school year, the Oklahoma Department of Commerce,~~
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26 the Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, shall
27 review and approve career-readiness assessments and assessment-based
28 credentials that measure and document foundational workplace skills.

1 Beginning with the ~~2019-2020~~ 2026-2027 school year, the assessments
2 shall be made available to all public school districts to be
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4 administration to students in grades ten through twelve at least
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17 limited to:

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23 specific industries and occupations;

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1 5. Lead to nationally recognized work-readiness certificates or
2 credentials for students who meet the minimum proficiency
3 requirements on the component assessments; and

4 6. Be available in paper- and computer-based formats.

5 B. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, in
6 consultation with the American Council on Education National Guide,
7 shall promulgate rules to allow institutions of higher education
8 within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education to grant
9 college credit based on assessment-based credentials and scores
10 earned on career-readiness assessments.

11 SECTION 5. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

12 SECTION 6. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
13 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
14 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
15 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

1 Passed the Senate the 10th day of March, 2026.

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4 Presiding Officer of the Senate

5 Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
6 2026.

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8 _____
9 Presiding Officer of the House
10 of Representatives